

Varad Raskar

Aspiring Red Team Operator / Penetration Tester

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SUMMARY

CS undergraduate and cybersecurity intern with hands-on production Linux administration, security auditing, and infrastructure deployment experience. Root-access exposure to real production systems, recurring subdomain security assessments, and a growing offensive-security skill set (Linux, networking, web security fundamentals) targeted at red teaming and penetration testing, with secondary strength in secure backend development.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Intern

Pixaflip Technologies

June 2026 – Present

- Granted root-level access to production Linux servers — beyond standard intern scope — to audit and harden system configurations, reporting findings directly to the CEO as part of a 3-person team.
- Conducted recurring security assessments of company subdomains, identifying and remediating missing HTTP security headers and implementing previously absent rate limiting to reduce exposure to abuse.
- Deployed and configured Coolify, a self-hosted deployment platform, on the primary production server — including reverse proxy and domain/SSL setup — to standardize application deployment.
- Helped architect and stand up a backup server, migrating subdomains and establishing live data synchronization with the primary server to improve infrastructure resilience.
- Administered production infrastructure spanning Docker, Nginx, PM2, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, and MinIO, using Nmap, OpenSSL, cURL, dig, and nslookup for diagnostics and reconnaissance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, MySQL, C,C++

Operating Systems: Linux, Ubuntu, Kali Linux, Windows

Security: Web Security Fundamentals, OWASP Top 10, HTTP Security Headers, SSL/TLS, HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, TCP/IP, SSH

Infrastructure: Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx, PM2, Coolify, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, MinIO, Git, VirtualBox

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco Networking Academy — Linux Unhatched (Verified)
- HackEthics — 4-Day Ethical Hacking Workshop (Microsoft Learn Student Ambassadors)
- Hands-on Bootcamp on Artificial Intelligence — BlockseBlock & OpenxAI (Aug 2025)
- Basics of Training & Leadership — UniAthena & Cambridge International Qualifications

In Progress: CEH | CompTIA Security+ | CompTIA PenTest+

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.), Computer Science and Engineering

Lovely Professional University (LPU), Phagwara, Punjab | Expected Graduation: May 2029

ADDITIONAL

Learning Platforms: Hack The Box, PortSwigger Web Security Academy, Cisco Networking Academy, IBM SkillsBuild, SWAYAM, NPTEL, freeCodeCamp

Research: Co-authoring a research paper on AI-driven defensive security validation, in progress, targeting a peer-reviewed security journal

Languages: English, Hindi, Marathi